property should be recognized and compensated in a fair manner. Requirements of giving jobs and annuities should be done away with.

Land for industrialization, infrastructure, housing and other private non-agricultural purposes should become a private transaction. The law should be used only for limited purposes.

Land Reforms for Slum Development

There are no good and reliable official estimates available for the urban slum population in India. The World Bank estimates that 35 per cent of India’s urban population lives in slums, which puts the number at about 13–14 crore now.

No good estimates of land area occupied by slums are available as these are not recorded in any official system.

Two basic facts need to be noted. First, most slums are built invariably on land belonging to government and local authorities. A survey estimated that 60 per cent of slum land is government land; the balance belongs to local bodies. Second, slums are almost always inhabited by migrants. Those migrants who come to cities in search of work and are unable to find an affordable rental to live and work from end up finding shelter in slums.

The economic policies pursued by India are responsible for creating slums. The fact that elite urban planning did not envisage the need to build affordable housing and rental places where such supply was needed is reflected in the location of slums. Renting as a policy for housing was totally decimated by a misconceived policy of rent control and the almost impossible ejection of the tenant.

The private sector did not build affordable rentable apartments for migrants in cities. Government planners did not allow any such housing to come up as well. The result was an absolute shortage of affordable housing, leading to slums mushrooming on government lands. While the programmes undertaken by the Centre and states would somewhat improve